



NSW Education Standards Authority

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Centre Number

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Student Number

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Ancient History

General Instructions

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – 3 hours
- Write using black pen
- A Source Booklet is provided with this paper
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page

Total marks:
100

Section I – 25 marks (pages 2–8)

- Attempt Questions 1–4
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 9–11)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 5–12
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section III – 25 marks (pages 12–16)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 13–22
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section IV – 25 marks (pages 17–20)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 23–32
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section I — Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum

25 marks

Attempt Questions 1–4

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Refer to the Source Booklet to answer Questions 1–4.

Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Extra writing space is provided on pages 7–8 of this booklet. If you use this space, clearly indicate which question you are answering.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 1 (3 marks)

Outline the contribution of ONE archaeologist to our understanding of Pompeii OR Herculaneum.

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Question 2 (5 marks)

Explain what archaeological evidence reveals about food and dining in Pompeii and Herculaneum. Support your response using Source A and your own knowledge.

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Which culture had more influence in Pompeii and Herculaneum: Greek or Egyptian? Support your response using evidence from Sources *B* and *C* and other relevant sources.

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Section I extra writing space

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Section I extra writing space

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Ancient History

Section II — Ancient Societies

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 5–12

Answer ALL parts of the question

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 2–8 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 5 — Option A: New Kingdom Egypt society to the death of Amenhotep III (25 marks)

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----------|
| (a) | Outline the role of royal women during this period. | 3 |
| (b) | How did the Nile contribute to the Egyptian economy during this period? | 4 |
| (c) | Explain the importance of myths and legends for Egyptian religious beliefs during this period. | 6 |
| (d) | What does art reveal about society in New Kingdom Egypt during this period? Support your response using evidence from relevant sources. | 12 |

Question 6 — Option B: New Kingdom Egypt society during the Ramesside period (25 marks)

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----------|
| (a) | Outline the role of the army during this period. | 3 |
| (b) | How did technology contribute to the Egyptian economy during this period? | 4 |
| (c) | Explain the significance of funerary customs in Egypt during this period. | 6 |
| (d) | What does art reveal about society in New Kingdom Egypt during this period? Support your response using evidence from relevant sources. | 12 |

Question 7 — Option C: Society in Israel from Solomon to the fall of Samaria
(25 marks)

- (a) Outline the natural features of Israel during this period. **3**
- (b) How did trade contribute to the economy of Israel during this period? **4**
- (c) Explain the importance of conflicting religious beliefs and practices in Israel during this period. **6**
- (d) What does evidence reveal about the social structure of Israel during this period? **12**
Support your response using evidence from relevant sources.

Question 8 — Option D: Persian society at the time of Darius and Xerxes
(25 marks)

- (a) Outline leisure activities in Persian society during this period. **3**
- (b) How did technology contribute to Persian society during this period? **4**
- (c) Explain the purpose of art in Persian society during this period. **6**
- (d) What does evidence reveal about the relationship between Persia and the peoples within its empire during this period? Support your response using evidence from relevant sources. **12**

Question 9 — Option E: Society in China during the Han Dynasty
206 BC – AD 220 (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the natural features of China during this period. **3**
- (b) How did the mandate of heaven shape politics in China during this period? **4**
- (c) Explain the role and status of women during this period. **6**
- (d) What does evidence reveal about the economy in China during this period? **12**
Support your response using evidence from relevant sources.

Question 10 — Option F: Bronze Age – Minoan Crete (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the natural features of Minoan Crete during this period. **3**
- (b) How did towns contribute to society in Minoan Crete during this period? **4**
- (c) Explain the importance of myths and legends relating to the Minoans during this period. **6**
- (d) What does art reveal about society in Minoan Crete during this period? Support your response using evidence from relevant sources. **12**

Question 11 — Option G: Spartan society to the Battle of Leuctra 371 BC (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the natural features of Sparta during this period. **3**
- (b) How did Greek writers view Spartan society during this period? **4**
- (c) Explain the importance of myths and legends for Spartan society during this period. **6**
- (d) What does evidence reveal about Spartan social structure during this period? Support your response using evidence from relevant sources. **12**

Question 12 — Option H: Athenian society in the time of Pericles (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the natural features of Athens during this period. **3**
- (b) How did the Agora contribute to Athenian society during the time of Pericles? **4**
- (c) Explain the importance of myths and legends for Athenian society during this period. **6**
- (d) What does evidence reveal about Athenian social structure during this period? Support your response using evidence from relevant sources. **12**

Section III — Personalities in their Times

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 13–22

Answer BOTH parts of the question

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 10–16 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 13 — Option A: Egypt – Hatshepsut (25 marks)

- (a) How was Hatshepsut shaped by her context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

Hatchepsut herself was deeply aware of – some might even say obsessed by – her country’s recent past, and her reign is characterized by a burning desire to recreate the splendours of the 12th Dynasty, a golden age when Egypt had prospered under the succession of strong kings...To the Egyptians, always a highly conservative people, stability and continuity were vitally important signs that all was well with their world.*

JOYCE A TYLDESLEY

Hatchepsut: The Female Pharaoh*, 1998

* Hatchepsut

Hatshepsut

With kind permission of Dr Joyce Tyldesley – Author

- (b) To what extent was Hatshepsut successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 14 — Option B: Egypt – Akhenaten (25 marks)

- (a) How was Akhenaten shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

An assessment of the Amarna episode's significance should be set in the larger historical and cultural context into which Akhenaten was born and against which he reacted. Much has been written about the motivation for the changes of his reign... People generally assume that the prime mover was the king. For religious matters, in particular, antecedents to many elements have been identified.*

DAVID O'CONNOR and Eric H CLINE, 'Dawn of the Amarna Age'
Amenhotep III: Perspectives on His Reign, 2001

* antecedents *earlier examples or causes*

From *Amenhotep III: Perspectives on his Reign*, ed David O'Connor and Eric H Cline, University of Michigan Press 2001

- (b) To what extent was Akhenaten successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 15 — Option C: The Near East – Sennacherib (25 marks)

- (a) How was Sennacherib shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

Shocked and traumatized by Sargon's fate, Sennacherib seems to have felt a strong need to distance himself from his fallen father and predecessor – whose end he considered a cruel punishment inflicted by the gods... Sennacherib tried to erase the memory of his father... Sennacherib also sought revenge.

ECKART FRAHM
Assyria: The Rise and Fall of the World's First Empire, 2023

- (b) To what extent was Sennacherib successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 16 — Option D: The Near East – Xerxes (25 marks)

- (a) How was Xerxes shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

When Darius died in 486 BC, Xerxes inherited his problems with his kingdom. Perhaps he was always under the shadow of his great father; much of his reign seems to consist of dealing with Darius' unfinished business. In order to live up to his great father he must prove himself a great conqueror ...

RICHARD STONEMAN, *Xerxes: A Persian Life*, 2015

Xerxes: A Persian Life – Yale Representation Ltd. Reproduced with permission of the Licensor through PLSclear

- (b) To what extent was Xerxes successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 17 — Option E: China – Qin Shihuangdi (25 marks)

- (a) How was Qin Shihuangdi shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

The state of Qin...was one which had already initiated great changes in the centralization of tax collection and agricultural control as well as in water management...The conquest of other Warring States had also begun in the centuries before the First Emperor. He inherited ideas about centralized administration, law and legal responsibility...

FRANCES WOOD, *The first emperor of China*, 2008

- (b) To what extent was Qin Shihuangdi successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 18 — Option F: Greece – Pericles (25 marks)

- (a) How was Pericles shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

During these years [late sixth and early fifth centuries], internal and external wars...determined not only the form of Athens' democratic government and political independence, but even its physical survival as a community...Pericles' career became the story of a...political leader whose ideas and policies were forever shaped by what he had as a child learned from his family about their deeply controversial history.

THOMAS R MARTIN

Pericles: A Biography in Context, 2016

Pericles: A Biography in Context. Reproduced with permission of the Licensor through PLSclear

- (b) To what extent was Pericles successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 19 — Option G: Greece – Alexander the Great (25 marks)

- (a) How was Alexander shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

The world that Alexander was born into and grew up in had three main political and cultural dimensions. First there was the kingdom of Macedon itself... Then there was the old Greek world to the south and east of Macedon... Finally, there was the Persian Empire, ... which ... periodically occupied or threatened to occupy the land of the Greeks who lived on the westernmost fringes of Asia.

PAUL CARTLEDGE

Alexander the Great: The Truth Behind the Myth, 2011

Published in 2004 by Macmillan, an imprint of Pan Macmillan
Reproduced by permission of Macmillan Publishers International Limited
© Paul Cartledge, 2004

- (b) To what extent was Alexander successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 20 — Option H: Rome – Tiberius Gracchus (25 marks)

- (a) How was Tiberius Gracchus shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

The desire to honour the glory of one's father by emulating his success in the service of the republic, whether in war, empire-building or politics, was among the key motivations of the Roman aristocratic élite... For Tiberius's short, controversial life intersected with a key turning point – a crisis... centred on the question of who would benefit from the empire Rome had so quickly acquired – the rich or the poor?

SIMON BAKER

Ancient Rome: The Rise and Fall of an Empire, 2006

Published by BBC Books 2006.
Reprinted by permission of The Random House Group Limited.

- (b) To what extent was Tiberius Gracchus successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 21 — Option I: Rome – Julius Caesar (25 marks)

- (a) How was Julius Caesar shaped by his context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

[Caesar grew up in] the best of times and the worst of times. It was the worst of times because he was born into a family that found themselves on the wrong side of a continuing struggle ... between the traditional ruling aristocracy and the people ... It was the best of times for someone like Caesar ... because of the opportunity to be a general in the Roman world ...

MARIA WYKE

In Our Time, BBC Radio 4, 2014

- (b) To what extent was Julius Caesar successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Question 22 — Option J: Rome – Agrippina the Younger (25 marks)

- (a) How was Agrippina the Younger shaped by her context? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **10**

Agrippina was born to power, and also its shadow ... War had taken her father from Rome and politics had taken her mother. Indeed, mother set daughter a rigorous example, which was probably just as well. She did not see much of her father, he was dead by the time she was four. Her family never forgot its station.*

BILL LEADBETTER

The Ambition of Agrippina the Younger, 1995

* station *status*

© Macquarie University

- (b) To what extent was Agrippina the Younger successful? Support your response using relevant sources. **15**

Section IV — Historical Periods

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 23–32

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 18–24 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - use relevant sources and interpretation to support your response
 - communicate ideas and information using historical terms and concepts appropriately
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
-

Question 23 — Option A: New Kingdom Egypt to the Death of Thutmose IV (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent was the cult of Amun important to internal developments during this period? **25**

OR

- (b) Assess Egypt's relations with Nubia, Syria-Palestine and Mitanni during this period. **25**

Question 24 — Option B: New Kingdom Egypt – Amenhotep III to the Death of Ramesses II (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the role and contribution of the post-Amarna pharaohs up until the death of Horemheb. **25**

OR

- (b) Assess the nature of Ramesside imperialism. **25**

Question 25 — Option C: The Ancient Levant – First Temple Period
c. 970–586 BC (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent did the division of the kingdoms of Israel and Judah under Rehoboam have an effect on the Levant during this period? **25**

OR

- (b) To what extent were Judah's relations with Assyria more significant than those with Babylon during this period? **25**

Question 26 — Option D: Persia – Cyrus II to the Death of Darius III
(25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the significance of the reign of Cyrus II for the development of Persia and its empire. **25**

OR

- (b) Assess the nature of Persian expansion during this period. **25**

Question 27 — Option E: Imperial China – The Qin and Han 247–87 BC
(25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the importance of the unification of the Warring States during this period. **25**

OR

- (b) Assess the contribution of Emperor Wendi to the establishment of the Han dynasty. **25**

Question 28 — Option F: The Greek World 500–440 BC (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent were the Battles of Thermopylae and Artemisium a success for the Greeks during the Persian invasion of 480–479 BC? **25**

OR

- (b) Assess the significance of key democratic developments within Athens during this period. **25**

Question 29 — Option G: 4th-Century Greece to the Death of Philip II (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the impact of the Macedonian expansion on Greece during this period. **25**

OR

- (b) To what extent was Spartan hegemony successful during this period? **25**

Question 30 — Option H: The Fall of the Roman Republic 78–31 BC (25 marks)

- (a) Assess the significance of the relationship between Pompey and Crassus during this period. **25**

OR

- (b) To what extent did urban violence contribute to the fall of the Roman Republic? **25**

Please turn over

Question 31 — Option I: The Augustan Age 44 BC – AD 14 (25 marks)

- (a) Assess the reasons for the establishment of the principate. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate Augustus' relationship with the Senate during this period. **25**

Question 32 — Option J: The Julio-Claudians AD 14–69 (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent did the death of Augustus shape the Julio-Claudian principate? **25**

OR

- (b) Assess which Julio-Claudian ruler was most successful in their reforms and policies during this period. **25**

End of paper



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Ancient History

Source Booklet

**Sources
A – E**

Source A (page 2)

Source B (page 2)

Source C (page 3)

Source D (page 3)

Source E (page 3)

Source A

A price list for a food stall from *Regio II* at Pompeii

<i>Product</i>	<i>Price</i>
Wine	$1\frac{1}{2}$ asses*
Cheese	$1\frac{1}{2}$ asses
Olive oil	1 as
Bread	$2\frac{1}{2}$ asses
Pork	4 asses

* as(ses) *Low value bronze coin(s)*

© The Ancient Graffiti Project

Source B

Fresco from Herculaneum depicting goddesses and Hercules on Mount Olympus



© commons.wikimedia.org

Source C

The overall impression is one of cultural mix... We see this mixture too in the best-preserved statue of Isis from the complex*. This statue was made in the first century CE, adopting a Greek style of sculpture of several hundred years earlier. She is hardly Egyptian at all...

MARY BEARD, *Pompeii*, 2008

* complex *Religious precinct*

Source D

Forum of Pompeii



Source E

Our evidence [from Herculaneum] is certainly incomplete, and surprises surely await any future campaign of excavation... What else is missing? Certainly a few temples. There was a Capitolium – a temple to Jupiter... And there must have been a temple to Hercules... Then there is the mysterious Temple of Mother of Gods, Magna Mater, restored by the Emperor Vespasian in AD 76... There is a missing Macellum, or market, built at his own expense by the duumvir Marcus Spurius, son of Marcus Rufus. The unexcavated town undoubtedly has other surprises in store. But from what we can make out, this small community, no more than a modern village, boasted an impressive and well-organized set of public monuments, deliberately imitating the style of imperial Rome... imperial Herculaneum, though small, was disproportionately well endowed.

ANDREW WALLACE-HADRILL, *Herculaneum*, 2011

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